



Aarav is India's 93rd Grandmaster



Aarav Dengla has become the 93rd Indian to earn the title of chess Grandmaster after completing all the formalities required for the coveted distinction.

He secured his third and final GM norm, crossing the 2500 rating mark, with his classical live rating reaching 2506.

The 17-year-old from Mumbai achieved the feat after winning the GM Mix Bijeljina and the GM-norm Round Robin Tournament consecutively in Bosnia and Herzegovina.

Dengla had earned his first GM norm at the 1st International Grandmaster Tournament in Bijeljina in 2022, while his second came at the Zupanja Celebrates Chess GM-norm Round Robin in Croatia in 2025.

Among his other notable achievements are victories at the 2024 Grand Paris Masters Championship and the FIDE World Schools Rapid and Blitz Championships in the same year.

Dengla is the second Indian to attain the GM title in 2026, after Aaryan Varshney achieved the milestone in January.

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1

Following India's bid to host the 2028 Asian Indoor Athletics

Championships, a two-member delegation from the Asian Athletics Association (AAA), comprising competition director C.K. Valson and secretary general A. Shuggumarran, inspected the indoor track at Kalinga Stadium in Bhubaneswar.

"It was a site visit as India has bid to host the 2028 Asian Indoor Championships. We looked at the hotels, the stadium and the indoor facility. The state government is keen to host it. If everything goes well, it will be staged here," Valson told *Sportstar*.

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Riaan Nandankar of Gujarat and Asees Barar of Punjab emerged as

boys' and girls' singles champions, respectively, at the 20th Ramesh Desai Nationals Under-12 Tennis Tournament, organised by Maharashtra State Lawn Tennis Association (MSLTA) and played at GA Ranade Tennis Centre. In the boys' final, top-seeded Riaan registered a 6-1, 6-4 win over Karnataka's BC Thanush to win the title. In the girls' final, Asees struggled before getting past Tamil Nadu girl Vaishnavi Balajee 6-2, 4-6, 6-2.

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